

CAT-H (Children's Apperception Test — Human Version)

COMPREHENSIVE ANALYSIS SHEET

Patient Information

Field	Details
Name	AP
Age	16 years
Test Administered	CAT-H (Children's Apperception Test — Human Version; Bellak & Bellak, 1965)
Scoring Framework	Bellak's 10 Variables System (Leopold Bellak, M.D., 5th Edition)
Need-Press System	Henry Murray's Need-Press Framework
Language of Responses	Hindi (with English translation)
Note	CAT-H uses human figures substituted for the original animal figures of the CAT-A. Designed for children ages 7–10+ and those with higher I.Q.s who respond better to human stimuli. The 10 scoring variables and interpretation framework remain identical.

CARD 1

(Children seated around a table with food; an adult figure in background)

Response Summary

Three children and their father. Subject references a similar movie. Originally 5–6 siblings. Father kills any child who speaks against him or does wrong, and makes the other children eat them. Mother died while cooking food. The father developed

trauma related to food after the mother's death. He started killing and feeding children to each other one by one. The child sitting in the corner ultimately escapes, calls the police, and saves himself. Father is caught by police. Children's ages were 6–8 years.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: A father systematically kills his children and forces the surviving ones to eat them. The mother had died while cooking. One child, sitting in the corner, escapes and calls the police.

Interpretive Level: If one lives under a traumatized, violent authority figure, survival depends on being overlooked and marginalized. Only external institutional help (police) can provide rescue — personal agency is insufficient.

Diagnostic Level: Profound fear of a destructive, cannibalistic paternal figure. Oral-aggressive themes dominate (eating/being eaten). The family is perceived as a site of annihilation rather than safety. The nurturing figure (mother) is destroyed in the very act of providing care. Survival requires invisibility and external intervention.

Symbolic Level: Cannibalism = incorporation/destruction of identity and autonomy; Mother dying while cooking = nurturance destroyed at its source; Corner child = the marginalized, overlooked self who survives precisely because of insignificance; Police = external moral authority more reliable than family.

2. Main Hero

Identification: Father is explicitly stated as main character. However, the surviving corner child functions as the self-identification figure.

Adequacy of Hero: Father-hero is profoundly inadequate — driven by trauma, mental illness, and anger to destroy his own children. The corner child shows minimal adequacy — can only escape and seek help, not actively fight.

Self-Image: Small, vulnerable, powerless, at the mercy of damaged authority. The body is conceived as potential food — an object to be consumed. Survival depends on being unnoticed.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

Behavioral Needs: - n Aggression (Father): Extreme — murder and cannibalistic acts
 - n Dominance (Father): Total control through lethal violence
 - n Harm Avoidance (Child): Primary drive is escape/survival
 - n Succorance (Child): Seeks external help (police)

Figures/Objects/Circumstances Introduced: - Police — external rescue/justice (significant) - Multiple siblings (5–6) systematically eliminated - Cannibalism — forcing children to eat siblings (highly significant oral-aggressive content) - Trauma and mental illness as causal explanation - Movie reference as distancing device

Figures/Objects/Circumstances Omitted: - No nurturing figure after mother's death - No sibling alliance or peer support - No internal coping mechanism

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Extremely dangerous, violent, unpredictable. The home is a place of death. Authority figures are mentally unstable and destructive. No natural protection exists — safety requires institutional intervention. Trauma generates endless cycles of violence.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Father:** Traumatized, mentally ill, cannibalistic, murderous — the ultimate threat. Aggression attributed to trauma (wife's death) and anger issues. Simultaneously provider and destroyer.
 - **Mother:** Absent — died performing a nurturing act (cooking). Idealized through absence. Her death catalyzes father's deterioration.
 - **Siblings:** Helpless victims, consumed by paternal aggression.
 - **Police:** Only source of justice — impersonal external authority more trustworthy than family.
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6. Significant Conflicts

- Survival vs. Annihilation — existing in a family where visibility means destruction
 - Trust vs. Fear of Authority — the protector is the destroyer
 - Oral Incorporation vs. Oral Aggression — food as both nurturance and destruction
 - Dependence vs. Autonomy — dependent on a lethal provider
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7. Nature of Anxieties

- Physical annihilation anxiety (primary)
- Fear of being consumed/incorporated (oral-cannibalistic)
- Loss of nurturing object (mother's death)
- Fear of unpredictable paternal aggression
- Helplessness/abandonment — no reliable caretaker

8. Main Defenses

- **Projection:** All aggression placed in the father figure
- **Externalization:** Solution comes from outside (police)
- **Rationalization:** Father's acts explained by "trauma" and "mental issues"
- **Distancing:** Story framed as a movie reference
- **Splitting:** Good (children/police) vs. Evil (father) — no ambivalence
- **Identification with marginalized position:** Surviving by being overlooked

9. Adequacy of Superego

Punishment is proportionate — father caught by police. Superego functions through external institutional authority rather than internal moral reckoning. Father shows no remorse; punishment is imposed, not self-generated. Suggests reliance on external enforcement rather than internalized moral standards.

10. Integration of the Ego

Moderate-to-Poor. Story is narratively coherent with logical structure, suggesting adequate formal thought processes. However: - Extreme aggressive/destructive content - Inability to resolve through personal agency - Movie reference as distancing suggests awareness that content is disturbing - Causality maintained (trauma illness aggression) - Reality testing preserved (police intervention is realistic) - Oral-cannibalistic content suggests significant anxiety breakthrough

Murray's Need-Press Table:

Need	Press
n Aggression (Father)	p Aggression (physical, extreme)
n Harm Avoidance (Child)	p Dominance (Father over children)
n Succorance (Child Police)	p Rejection (of children's needs)
n Autonomy (escape)	p Loss (of mother/nurturance)
—	p Physical Danger (life-threatening)

CARD 2

(Three human figures in a rope-pulling scene; one figure alone on one side, two on the other)

Response Summary

Three siblings on a mountain. The one on the left is arrogant, the middle one is smart (main character), the smaller one is innocent. They play a competitive game with frequent fighting; they don't tell parents. They go to a mountain and decide whoever wins stays alive — losers fall off. The smart one uses his technique to save both others but falls and dies himself. He chose to sacrifice because: he's not the parents' favourite, not academically good — "mere marne se kam se kam loss hai." Parents cried but not much. The arrogant one reformed after witnessing the sacrifice. Mom-dad cried less than they would have for the other two. Main character was 12 years old; smaller one was 8.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: Three siblings compete on a mountain in a life-or-death game. The smart middle child deliberately sacrifices himself to save the other two, believing his life has the least value since he is neither the parents' favourite nor academically superior.

Interpretive Level: If one is neither the favourite nor the achiever, one's life is expendable. Self-sacrifice becomes the only meaningful act for the invisible, unvalued child. Love is conditional and hierarchical.

Diagnostic Level: Profound feelings of worthlessness, expendability, and being unvalued within the family. Self-sacrificial/suicidal ideation as a response to perceived lack of value. Depressive cognitions about conditional parental love. The "logical" self-destruction reveals how deeply internalized the belief in one's own dispensability is.

Symbolic Level: Mountain = life's competitive arena; Falling = death/failure; Self-sacrifice = martyrdom as only path to significance; Parents crying "not that much" = confirmation of worthlessness; Arrogant one reforming = sacrifice creates meaning post-mortem that life could not.

2. Main Hero

Identification: The "smart one" (middle child, age 12) — explicitly stated. AP identifies with the intelligent but unrecognized child.

Adequacy of Hero: Paradoxically adequate (saves others through sacrifice) and deeply inadequate (cannot find a reason to live, sees self as expendable). Adequacy expressed only through self-destruction.

Self-Image: Worthless, invisible, dispensable. Not the favourite, not the best at anything recognized. Intelligence exists but is unacknowledged. Self conceived as having the least "loss value" among siblings.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

Behavioral Needs: - n Affiliation/Love (primary, unmet): Desperately wants parental recognition - n Recognition (thwarted): Feels unacknowledged - n Abasement/Self-Sacrifice: Turns aggression inward - n Nurturance (toward siblings): Saves others through death - n Achievement (blocked): Others are better at studies; no acknowledged domain

Figures/Objects/Circumstances Introduced: - Life-or-death competition (significant) - Parental favouritism (younger = favourite, older = academically good) - Self-sacrifice as "logical" solution - Parents' minimal grief — "roye bas thode time tak" - Arrogant sibling's reformation through witnessing sacrifice

Figures/Objects/Circumstances Omitted: - No attempt to communicate feelings to anyone - No adult intervention or protection - No anger expressed toward parents (aggression turned inward) - No alternative solution considered

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

A competitive arena where worth is measured by tangible qualities (academics, being the youngest). Those without visible worth are expendable. Love is conditional and hierarchical. The environment does not value quiet intelligence. Death/sacrifice is the only act that creates meaning for the unvalued.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Parents:** Conditionally loving, favouritistic, indifferent to middle child's existence and even death. They are unjust distributors of affection.
- **Younger Sibling:** The favourite. Receives unconditional love by simply being young.

- **Arrogant/Older Sibling:** Academically excellent, competitive, initially flawed but redeemable.
 - **Self (Smart One):** Invisible, unvalued, possessing wisdom nobody acknowledges. Exists in a relational void.
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6. Significant Conflicts

- Self-Worth vs. Perceived Worthlessness
 - Need for Love vs. Acceptance of Rejection
 - Aggression (toward parents/siblings) vs. Self-Directed Aggression (retroflexion)
 - Autonomy vs. Belonging — cannot find a place in the family
 - Life vs. Death — existence itself is conditional on "winning"
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7. Nature of Anxieties

- Fear of being unloved/unvalued (primary)
 - Fear of insignificance — not mattering to anyone
 - Abandonment anxiety — even in death, parents don't fully mourn
 - Competitive anxiety — compared and found wanting
 - Existential anxiety — questioning purpose of existence
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8. Main Defenses

- **Turning Against Self (Retroflexion):** All aggression directed inward as self-sacrifice
 - **Rationalization:** "Mere marne se loss kam hai" — logical justification for self-destruction
 - **Reaction Formation:** Hostility toward family converted to noble sacrifice
 - **Intellectualization:** Uses logic to arrive at self-destruction
 - **Altruistic Surrender:** Gives up life so "more valued" others can live
 - **Denial:** Denies anger toward parents; presents acceptance instead of rage
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9. Adequacy of Superego

Extremely harsh, primitive superego. The "crime" is merely existing without being exceptional — punishment is death. Massively punitive: no actual crime committed, yet death is the consequence. The arrogant sibling reforms (mild consequence for actual flaws) while the innocent smart child dies (severe consequence for perceived inadequacy). Consistent with **depressive dynamics and passive suicidal ideation**.

10. Integration of the Ego

Poor ego integration with depressive features. Story is well-structured and detailed (adequate cognitive functioning), but: - "Solution" is self-destruction — ego overwhelmed by internalized aggression - No adaptive coping mechanism employed - Hero cannot find ANY reason to live — severe hopelessness - Detailed elaboration suggests strong preoccupation - Reveals passive suicidal ideation framed as noble sacrifice - Reality testing partially maintained (story internally consistent) - Extended emotional investment is clinically significant

Murray's Need-Press Table:

Need	Press
n Affiliation (unmet)	p Rejection (by parents)
n Recognition (unmet)	p Dominance (sibling competition)
n Abasement (self-sacrifice)	p Inferiority (compared to siblings)
n Nurturance (toward siblings)	p Loss (of love, of place)
n Autonomy (choosing own death)	p Devaluation (by family system)

CLINICAL FLAG: Significant depressive ideation, feelings of worthlessness, and passive suicidal themes. The narrative of self-sacrifice as "logical" for someone "less valued" warrants careful clinical attention.

CARD 3

(An adult authority/father figure seated; a small child figure nearby)

Response Summary

Batman-like story. Father was busy with work. Child had everything materially but not love. Father was shot and killed by someone. Child inherited everything but was still unhappy. Then he became good — helped others with his money, supported people, lived a happy life. Father loved the child but couldn't express it. Connection was never built so the child couldn't express either. Father just died like that. Main character is the child. Father was shot by someone.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: A busy father who cannot express love is suddenly killed. The child inherits wealth but remains unhappy until he begins helping others and eventually lives a happy life.

Interpretive Level: If one's father is emotionally unavailable, his sudden loss leaves material abundance but emotional void. Healing comes through altruistic behaviour and connecting with others.

Diagnostic Level: Oedipal themes with emotional deprivation. Father "loves but cannot show it" — an attempt to preserve an idealized paternal image despite experienced neglect. Father's death by external agent may represent repressed hostile wishes. Resolution through generosity = reaction formation against angry/acquisitive impulses.

Symbolic Level: Father shot = oedipal wish disguised as external event; Wealth without love = emotional deprivation masked by provision; Helping others = undoing guilt over hostile wishes; Happy life after father's death = liberation fantasy.

2. Main Hero

Identification: The child — explicitly stated.

Adequacy of Hero: Initially passive and deprived. After father's death, shows adequate functioning — uses resources positively, helps others, achieves happiness. Adequacy emerges only after removal of the emotionally blocking authority figure.

Self-Image: Initially incomplete and unloved despite having "everything." Transforms into generous, connected person. Self needs emotional connection more than material provision.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

Behavioral Needs: - n Affiliation/Love (primary, unmet): Craves emotional connection with father - n Nurturance (giving): Helps others — becomes the nurturing figure he never had - n Achievement: Becomes "good" and socially valued - n Autonomy: Achieves independence post-death - n Acquisition (rejected): Has material wealth but finds it meaningless

Figures/Objects/Circumstances Introduced: - Shooting/murder of father (significant violent introduction) - Money/wealth as inadequate substitute for love - Helping others as path to happiness - Father's unexpressed love — "pyaar karta tha par bata nahi paya"

Figures/Objects/Circumstances Omitted: - Mother completely absent - Murderer unnamed/unknown — externalized aggression - No grief process described - No peers/friends

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Dangerous (people get shot) but offering opportunities for redemption through service. Authority figures are well-intentioned but emotionally incompetent. Connection and love must be actively created since they are not naturally provided.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Father:** Loving but emotionally blocked/unavailable. Busy, unable to express. Ultimately killed. Tragic rather than villainous. Both idealized and experienced as neglectful.
 - **Mother:** Completely absent — notable omission.
 - **"Someone" who shoots:** Anonymous aggressor — displaced hostile wish toward father.
 - **Others who receive help:** Substitutes for the connection never received.
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6. Significant Conflicts

- Need for love vs. Father's emotional unavailability (central)
- Gratitude for provision vs. Anger at emotional neglect

- Hostile wishes toward father vs. Guilt (father killed by "someone")
 - Dependence vs. Independence (freedom only after death)
 - Selfishness vs. Generosity (resolved through reaction formation)
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7. Nature of Anxieties

- Fear of emotional abandonment/neglect (primary)
 - Separation anxiety
 - Guilt over hostile wishes toward father
 - Fear of being emotionally stunted like father
 - Loss anxiety — sudden, violent, unprepared
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8. Main Defenses

- **Idealization:** Father "loved but couldn't show" — preserves good object
 - **Projection of aggression:** Someone else kills father
 - **Reaction Formation:** Anger at deprivation converted to generosity
 - **Undoing:** Helping others undoes guilt over hostile wishes
 - **Sublimation:** Unmet needs channeled into prosocial behaviour
 - **Denial:** Absence of grief; immediate pivot to "becoming good"
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9. Adequacy of Superego

Moderate functioning. Father's death externalized — child not punished since aggression sufficiently displaced. Child's "reward" (happy life) for goodness suggests a moral universe where prosocial behaviour is reinforced. Lack of mourning suggests superego lacunae regarding hostile wish. Allows sublimated aggression; rewards reparative behaviour.

10. Integration of the Ego

Moderate. Logical temporal progression (past → event → resolution). Positive: adaptive resolution through prosocial behaviour; recognition that wealth ≠ fulfillment; transformation of negative into positive. Concerning: father's death treated with emotional flatness (possible dissociation); mother entirely absent; Batman reference suggests reliance on cultural scripts; solution requires father's death for happiness.

Murray's Need-Press Table:

Need	Press
n Affiliation (primary, unmet)	p Rejection (emotional unavailability)
n Nurturance (giving)	p Loss (father's death)
n Achievement	p Lack (of emotional nurturance)
n Autonomy (post-death)	p Dominance (father's work over child)

CARD 4

(An adult figure (mother) carrying packages/basket; a child on a bicycle)

Response Summary

A mother who everyone thinks is irresponsible — she dresses up, takes money, goes out. But she actually goes out to buy things for her children. Only her children know the truth. She was formerly a model and liked spending money, which she continued after marriage. Elder child helped others understand the truth. Eventually everyone realized she was responsible. A monument was built in her honour. Mother took proper care of kids.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: A devoted mother is misunderstood by everyone as irresponsible. She actually spends money on her children. Her elder child helps reveal the truth. She is eventually honoured with a monument.

Interpretive Level: If one is a devoted caretaker whose efforts are misunderstood, truth eventually emerges through testimony of those who truly know you. Appearances are deceiving and good intentions will be validated.

Diagnostic Level: Strong idealization of the maternal figure with a need to defend her against criticism. Reflects need to restore the "good mother" image. Child becomes mother's advocate (parentification/role reversal). Former model identity suggests awareness of maternal narcissism reframed as devotion.

Symbolic Level: Mother going out = feared abandonment reframed as nurturing; Money/shopping = maternal provision disguised as selfishness; Monument = permanent validation; Elder child explaining = parentified child managing family reputation.

2. Main Hero

Identification: Mother is central figure; Elder Child is active agent who resolves conflict. Dual identification.

Adequacy of Hero: Mother is adequate in actual behaviour (responsible, devoted) but inadequate in self-advocacy — needs child to defend her. Elder child shows adequacy through advocacy.

Self-Image: Identifies with the misunderstood figure (true nature invisible to others)
OR the parentified child protecting the parent's reputation.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

- n Nurturance (Mother): Devoted caretaking
- n Recognition: Needs to be seen for true self
- n Defence (Elder Child): Defends mother's reputation
- n Affiliation: Needs social acceptance
- n Exhibition (past model life): Former public identity

Introduced: Social judgment; mother's past as model; monument; elder child as advocate; marriage as transformative.

Omitted: Father completely absent; no mother-child conflict; no negative maternal quality; no mention of mother's own needs.

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Judgmental, superficial — judges by appearances. Ultimately fair when truth emerges. Initially hostile to maternal figure but correctable through advocacy.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Mother:** Idealized, selfless, devoted, misunderstood. The perfect mother who gives everything.
 - **Elder Child:** Advocate, truth-teller, parentified protector.
 - **Society:** Judgmental but ultimately capable of recognition.
 - **Father:** Completely absent (notable).
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6. Significant Conflicts

- Appearance vs. Reality
 - Social judgment vs. Inner truth
 - Mother's past (model) vs. Current role (devoted mother)
 - Child's need to protect parent vs. Own needs (parentification)
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7. Nature of Anxieties

- Fear of social disapproval/judgment

- Fear of maternal loss (if discredited)
- Fear that "bad" version of mother might be true
- Separation anxiety (mother going "out")

8. Main Defenses

- **Idealization:** Mother perfectly devoted — no flaws
- **Splitting:** Those who understand (children) vs. Those who don't (society)
- **Reaction Formation:** Possible maternal neglect reframed as devotion
- **Denial:** No negative maternal qualities acknowledged
- **Undoing:** Monument "undoes" doubt
- **Role Reversal/Parentification:** Child protects mother

9. Adequacy of Superego

Lenient/Absent punishment — no actual wrongdoing; merely misunderstanding reversed. Monument as reward is somewhat grandiose. Suggests either well-integrated superego or inability to tolerate maternal ambivalence.

10. Integration of the Ego

Moderate-to-Good. Well-structured, coherent, reaches resolution. Clear narrative arc. Concerning: extreme maternal idealization; father's complete absence; parentification; monument ending is grandiose; need to completely exonerate mother may mask anger about actual maternal unavailability.

Murray's Need-Press Table:

Need	Press
n Defence (protecting mother)	p Social Disapproval
n Affiliation (acceptance)	p Rejection (by society initially)
n Recognition (for mother)	p Misunderstanding
n Nurture (mother children)	p Deception (appearances deceive)

CARD 5

(Two children in a small bed in a dimly lit room; a larger bed in background)

Response Summary

Two twin children (Jay and Vijay) with a perfect bond. Always together. Perfect children. Story revolves around their great bond. Parents never had tension; everyone was happy around them. Problems came but they handled them easily. Parents were proud. Relationship remained good into adulthood. Everyone wished they could be like them. Both twins are main characters.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: Twin children have a perfect, inseparable bond. They face no real difficulties, parents are proud, everyone admires them.

Interpretive Level: If one has a perfect relational bond, all problems become manageable. Parental pride and social admiration follow naturally.

Diagnostic Level: Compensatory wish-fulfillment fantasy. Stark contrast to sibling rivalry, competition, and violence in other cards. Represents the idealized solution to loneliness and expendability expressed in Card 2. Simplicity and lack of conflict suggest avoidance/denial.

Symbolic Level: Twins = idealized self-other merger; Perfect bond = symbiotic wish; "No tension for parents" = wish to be the problem-free child; Jay and Vijay = culturally significant names representing unity.

2. Main Hero

Identification: Both twins equally — dual identification reflecting wish for perfect mirroring.

Adequacy of Hero: Idealized — handle everything, never struggle. Represents wish fulfillment rather than realistic ego assessment.

Self-Image: The desired self — competent, bonded, admired, source of pride. Compensatory fantasy of who AP wishes to be.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

- n Affiliation (primary, fully met): Perfect bonding
- n Succorance (mutual): Twins support each other
- n Achievement: Handle all problems
- n Recognition: Admired by all, parents proud
- n Play: Life without significant struggle

Introduced: Idealized relationship; parental pride; social admiration; easily solved problems.

Omitted: Any conflict; real challenge; parental favouritism; death/violence; individual identity.

4–5. Conception of World / Figures Seen As

World is benign, supportive, admiring — complete contrast to other cards. Parents are proud and tension-free. Society is admiring. No negative figures exist.

6–7. Conflicts / Anxieties

Minimal overt conflict — precisely the point. The absence IS the defense. Underlying: merger vs. individuation; fantasy vs. reality. Anxieties defended against: separation, being alone, parental disappointment, conflict itself.

8. Main Defenses

- **Wish Fulfillment:** Entire story is defense against reality
 - **Idealization:** Perfect bond, parents, life
 - **Denial:** Complete denial of conflict, rivalry, negativity
 - **Reaction Formation:** Previous cards full of death; this one entirely peaceful
 - **Avoidance:** Brief, conflict-free, avoids depth
 - **Merger Fantasy:** Dissolving individual identity eliminates loneliness
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9. Adequacy of Superego

No crime, no punishment. Perfect children never transgress. Represents overly rigid superego that cannot tolerate wrongdoing OR an ego ideal serving as constant reproach to actual self.

10. Integration of the Ego

Appears good but is concerning. Coherent but extremely shallow. Suggests avoidant coping, constriction, inability to engage with complexity. Lacks the richness of other cards. The contrast with violent stories reveals significant **splitting** between idealized fantasy and destructive content.

CLINICAL NOTE: The stark oscillation between catastrophic violence (Cards 1, 2) and utopian wish fulfillment (Card 5) suggests limited capacity for moderate, realistic narrative.

CARD 6

(A dark shelter/tent-like structure with trees; two figures dimly seen inside; a child in the foreground)

Response Summary

Three siblings — two older responsible ones (Jay and Vijay) and a younger mischievous favourite. Parents tell older ones to look after the youngest. Youngest's mischief leads them out of home; they get lost in the jungle. Food and water run out because of youngest's behaviour. Eldest saves them from people with "galat intention" (kidnappers wanting ransom). Upon reunion, parents immediately hug youngest, ask if he's okay. Father asks older ones ONCE: "Tumhe kuch hua tha?" They say "hum theek hai" but realize: "Hume khud ke liye hi karna hai." Parents continue loving youngest more. Parents believe smaller child is better and will do better in life.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: Responsible older siblings care for a mischievous, favoured younger sibling. The youngest's behaviour leads to danger. The eldest saves everyone. Upon reunion, parents attend only to the youngest. Older children conclude they must rely on themselves.

Interpretive Level: If one is the responsible but unfavoured child, no amount of heroism earns love. One bears caretaking burdens without receiving love in return. Self-reliance is the only option.

Diagnostic Level: Repetition and confirmation of Card 2's core theme. Parentification without reciprocal love. "Hume khud ke liye hi karna hai" = premature emotional self-sufficiency born from parental neglect. The naming of heroes as Jay and Vijay (same as Card 5 twins) shows how the idealized twinship is contaminated by painful reality.

Symbolic Level: Jungle = dangerous unsupervised world; Getting lost = lack of genuine guidance; Kidnappers = adults who exploit; Parents hugging youngest first = confirmation of worthlessness.

2. Main Hero

Identification: Two older siblings (Jay and Vijay) — explicitly stated.

Adequacy of Hero: Highly adequate in competence (saves everyone) but emotionally unfulfilled and unrecognized. Competence brings no reward. The "competent but unloved" self.

Self-Image: Responsible, capable, forced into premature adulthood, unrecognized, emotionally starved.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

- n Nurturance (forced outward): Must care for younger sibling
- n Affiliation/Love (unmet): Craves parental recognition
- n Autonomy (forced): "Hume khud ke liye hi karna hai"
- n Achievement: Rescues siblings, navigates danger
- n Harm Avoidance: Protects from kidnappers

Introduced: Jungle/wilderness; kidnappers with ransom intent; parental differential treatment at reunion (highly significant); father asking "only once"; resource scarcity from youngest's behaviour.

Omitted: Positive parental interaction with older children; acknowledgment of heroism; anger expressed to parents; refusal to caretake.

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Unfair, exploitative, demanding. Parents are biased. Outside world contains predatory adults. Resources are scarce. Only one's own competence is reliable. Demands responsibility without offering nurturance.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Parents:** Unfair, favouritistic, emotionally neglectful of older children. Assign responsibility but give no reciprocity. Love is fixed — youngest gets it regardless.
 - **Younger Sibling:** Irresponsible, causes problems, yet loved unconditionally. The "loved without deserving" archetype.
 - **Kidnappers:** Exploitative adults — even help-givers have agendas.
 - **Older Siblings:** Responsible, heroic, capable but emotionally abandoned. Parentified.
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6. Significant Conflicts

- Caretaking obligation vs. Need to be cared for

- Competence vs. Recognition (being capable doesn't earn love)
 - Anger toward parents vs. Compliance
 - Resentment of younger sibling vs. Duty to protect
 - Dependence vs. Forced Independence
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7. Nature of Anxieties

- Fear of being unloved despite doing everything right (primary)
 - Fear of being parentified forever
 - Abandonment anxiety — parents' attention always elsewhere
 - Fear of exploitation — even helpers have motives
 - Fear that effort will never be enough
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8. Main Defenses

- **Identification with caretaker role:** Accepts parentification as identity
 - **Suppression:** "Hum theek hai" — keeps feelings hidden
 - **Denial of anger:** No direct rage toward parents
 - **Intellectualization:** Cold rational conclusion rather than emotional response
 - **Displacement:** Anger at parents displaced onto youngest's "shararat"
 - **Passive Aggression:** Detailed description of unfairness = indirect accusation
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9. Adequacy of Superego

Unbalanced/Unjust representation. Younger child commits "crime" (mischief) but receives no punishment — only love. Older children commit no crime but are "punished" with neglect. Mirrors deeply felt sense that moral universe is unjust — goodness is not rewarded.

10. Integration of the Ego

Moderate with significant depressive/resentful undertones. Highly coherent, emotionally rich. Strong cause-effect reasoning. Realistic resolution (acceptance). Problem-solving capacity. But: repetition of Card 2 theme = perseveration; "hume khud ke liye hi karna hai" = forced autonomy with underlying hopelessness; no challenge to unfair system = learned helplessness.

CLINICAL NOTE: Powerfully confirms core dynamic — AP experiences himself as the capable, responsible child whose efforts go unrecognized while a less-deserving sibling receives unconditional love. Likely reflects actual family dynamics.

CARD 7

(A threatening/grasping adult figure approaching a child; steaming kettle present)

Response Summary

An evil mother wastes money on beauty/food while the family is extremely poor. When money runs out, she kills the husband (who was dominated/submissive) in anger after he finally speaks up against her blaming. She stores his body. Then starts killing and eating the children. Children try to escape but cannot. Police get tips but arrive too late — she escapes. Mother killed father because of an argument — father was always "dab ke rehta tha" (submissive) but one day spoke up ("dominate kar raha tha"), so she killed him. Main character is the mother. "Buri kahani, bura end." The child witnessed father's death, loved father, but repeated father's "mistake" (speaking up) and suffered the same fate.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: A narcissistic, evil mother wastes resources on herself, kills her submissive husband when he finally speaks up, stores his body, then kills and eats her children. Police arrive too late. The child repeats the father's "mistake" and is also killed.

Interpretive Level: If one has a narcissistic, devouring mother, she will consume everyone. Those who speak against her (assert themselves) are destroyed. There is no escape. Victimhood is transmitted intergenerationally.

Diagnostic Level: Extreme oral-aggressive devouring maternal imagery. The "evil mother" = terrifying, engulfing maternal figure who consumes family for her own needs. Father's passivity until one moment of assertion = learned helplessness model. Child repeating father's pattern suggests identification with victim and fatalistic belief that challenging authority = annihilation. Severe maternal ambivalence expressed through splitting.

Symbolic Level: Eating children = maternal engulfment/narcissistic consumption; Beauty expenses = narcissism prioritized over children; Father killed for speaking up = assertion equals death; Police too late = help always fails; Stored body = hidden family secrets; Child repeating fate = intergenerational transmission.

2. Main Hero

Identification: Mother stated as main character "because this is not a good story." Father and child serve as identification figures — the passive victims.

Adequacy of Hero: Mother-villain is terrifyingly adequate in destructiveness (escapes justice). Father and child are completely inadequate — cannot protect themselves. Any assertion = destruction.

Self-Image: Vulnerable, trapped, unable to escape. Speaking up = death. Powerless against devouring authority.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

- n Aggression (Mother): Murders, cannibalizes
- n Acquisition/Narcissism (Mother): Beauty, self-gratification despite poverty
- n Dominance (Mother): Controls, destroys entire family
- n Harm Avoidance (Father/Child): Attempt to survive
- n Autonomy (Father's one moment): Speaking up = instantly punished
- n Abasement (Father): "Dab ke rehta tha" — submission

Introduced: Cannibalism (SECOND card); domestic violence; body storage; beauty/narcissism; failed police; intergenerational repetition; blame/scapegoating.

Omitted: Any nurturing maternal quality; successful escape; outside support; hope.

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Terrifying, inescapable, dominated by destructive figures facing no consequences. Help always arrives too late. The powerful destroy with impunity. No safe space — truth-telling = annihilation.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Mother (Evil):** Devouring, narcissistic, murderous, omnipotent. Escapes justice. "Bad mother" in most extreme form.
 - **Father:** Passive, dominated, submissive. One assertion = death. Model of learned helplessness.
 - **Children:** Helpless, trapped, consumed. Repeat victim patterns.
 - **Police:** Inadequate — always too late.
-

6. Significant Conflicts

- Submission vs. Assertion (speaking up = death)
 - Need for mother vs. Terror of mother
 - Self-preservation vs. Helplessness
 - Truth-telling vs. Self-protection
 - Oral needs vs. Oral aggression
 - Justice vs. Impunity
-

7. Nature of Anxieties

- Devouring/engulfment anxiety (primary)
 - Annihilation anxiety
 - Fear of assertion (speaking up = death)
 - Fear of maternal figure
 - Claustrophobic entrapment
 - Fear of intergenerational repetition
-

8. Main Defenses

- **Splitting:** Mother ALL bad — no redeeming qualities
 - **Projection:** Extreme aggression in maternal figure
 - **Identification with victim:** Repeats father's pattern
 - **Externalization:** "Buri kahani" — distancing commentary
 - **Repetition compulsion:** Intergenerational repetition = fatalism
 - **Helplessness as defense:** Escape impossible, no need to try
-

9. Adequacy of Superego

Absent/Failed. The criminal (evil mother) goes unpunished — escapes police. Victims punished for non-crimes (speaking up). Profoundly unjust moral universe: evil unpunished, innocence unprotective, justice systems fail, assertion treated as crime deserving death.

10. Integration of the Ego

Poor with overwhelmingly aggressive content. Narratively coherent; causality established; meta-commentary shows awareness ("buri kahani"). But: SECOND story with cannibalism (repetition of oral-aggressive fixation); no positive resolution;

intergenerational repetition = fatalism; extreme violence; assertion-death link = deep inhibition of self-expression; failed rescue reinforces helplessness.

CLINICAL FLAG: Second card with cannibalistic themes. Repeated oral-aggressive content combined with maternal devouring imagery, helplessness, and assertion-death link warrants significant clinical attention. May reflect experienced/witnessed domestic violence or severe maternal conflict.

CARD 8

(Adult figures seated/standing; one adult speaking to a child)

Response Summary

Good family — father, mother, child. Mother dies of cancer. Father remarries. Step-mother ("Lucy") is abusive — pinches, scolds, restricts. Everyone (neighbours) knows but nobody helps. Relatives don't know because step-mother acts well in front of them. Child perseveres through hard work, doesn't tell father. Eventually confronts step-mother ("takkar deke bahar nikal gaya"), leaves, builds own life, marries, creates own family, is happy. Father eventually divorces step-mother after child reveals truth. Step-mother was controlling ("iss ghar ki malkin hu"), liked expenses, targeted child because he was "simple."

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: A child loses his good mother to cancer. Father remarries an abusive step-mother. Despite witnessed abuse and community silence, the child perseveres through study and hard work, confronts the step-mother, escapes, and builds his own successful, happy life.

Interpretive Level: If one faces abuse from a replacement parental figure, one must rely entirely on one's own strength. Others may witness but won't intervene. Freedom comes through individual effort.

Diagnostic Level: Cinderella/persecuted child narrative. Biological mother idealized (dies = taken away, not abandoning). Step-mother = "bad mother" split. Father present but blind/ineffective. Child's self-reliance and escape represent healthy adaptive fantasy. Community silence suggests feelings of being failed by systems.

Symbolic Level: Cancer = blameless loss of good mother; Step-mother = persecutory replacement object; "Pinching" = invisible abuse; Neighbours knowing but not helping = community betrayal; Building own life = autonomous self-creation.

2. Main Hero

Identification: The child — explicitly the main character.

Adequacy of Hero: HIGH — perseveres, works hard, confronts abuser, builds own life. Most adequate hero across all cards.

Self-Image: Resilient, determined, "simple" but strong. Can triumph over oppression through effort. Healthiest self-concept in the protocol.

3. Main Needs and Drives of the Hero

- n Autonomy (primary): Self-liberation
- n Achievement: Studies, career, resources
- n Counteraction: Confronts step-mother
- n Affiliation: Creates new family
- n Harm Avoidance: Survives daily abuse
- n Dominance (healthy): Tells father truth

Introduced: Cancer; step-mother; remarriage; daily abuse; community silence; divorce; marriage; "Lucy" (Western name = distancing).

Omitted: Anger toward father for not protecting; grief for mother; any step-mother positive quality.

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Initially nurturing but fragile (good mother taken by cancer). Then abusive and indifferent (step-mother cruel, bystanders silent). BUT also contains opportunity for self-made success. Harsh but not inescapable.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Biological Mother:** Idealized, blameless, taken too early.
 - **Step-Mother ("Lucy"):** Abusive, narcissistic, territorial, deceptive.
 - **Father:** Present but blind/ineffective. Neither protector nor abuser.
 - **Neighbours:** Complicit through inaction.
 - **Life Partner:** Redemptive figure enabling happy ending.
-

6. Significant Conflicts

- Need for maternal love vs. Abusive maternal figure
 - Father's protection vs. Father's blindness
 - Simplicity/compliance vs. Need to fight back
 - Dependence vs. Need to escape
 - Trust vs. Deception
-

7. Nature of Anxieties

- Fear of replacement (good bad mother)
 - Fear of hidden/invisible abuse
 - Abandonment by protectors
 - Entrapment during childhood dependency
 - Loss anxiety (sudden maternal death)
-

8. Main Defenses

- **Splitting:** Biological mother = all good; Step-mother = all bad
 - **Idealization:** Biological mother perfect; future life perfect
 - **Counterphobic behaviour:** Confronts abuser directly
 - **Sublimation:** Channels suffering into hard work
 - **Distancing:** Foreign name "Lucy"; fairy-tale quality
 - **Delayed gratification:** Endures now to succeed later
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9. Adequacy of Superego

Proportionate and functional. Step-mother punished through divorce. Child rewarded with happy life. Most balanced moral universe across all cards. When subject mobilizes effective defenses (splitting, sublimation), superego functions adaptively.

10. Integration of the Ego

BEST ego integration across all cards. Complete narrative arc; adaptive resolution through personal agency; realistic coping (hard work, confrontation); delayed gratification; creation of healthy relationships; healthy assertion; mature defenses (sublimation, counterphobic action). This represents an ego ideal and therapeutic potential.

CLINICAL NOTE: Demonstrates that AP CAN mobilize healthy coping when narrative framework allows. Represents resilient self that overcomes through personal agency — potential therapeutic goal.

CARD 9

(A child in bed in a dark room, looking through an open door)

Response Summary

A child's father works out of station. Father only greets child in the morning, then leaves him with a careless servant. Servant neglects child for personal work. A snake enters the room. Child falls from bed. Just as snake is about to bite, father returns and saves him. Father fires servant and dedicates himself fully to raising the child. Father is the "hero of the story." Story ends with montage of father-child moments.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: A child left with an unreliable servant faces danger (snake). The absent father intuitively senses something is wrong, returns at the last moment, saves the child, fires the servant, and becomes a dedicated, present parent.

Interpretive Level: If left with unreliable substitutes, danger arises. Only the biological parent can truly protect. Crisis makes the absent father realize the child's need and transforms him.

Diagnostic Level: Wish-fulfillment rescue fantasy. Absent/busy father returns as savior and reforms. Snake = danger of parental absence. Careless servant = inadequate substitute. Reveals deep wish for paternal attention and the fantasy that crisis will force father to change.

Symbolic Level: Snake = phallic threat/danger in absence of protection; "Out of station" = emotional absence; Servant = inadequate substitute attachment; Father saving = rescue fantasy; Dedication afterwards = wished-for transformation.

2. Main Hero

Identification: Father explicitly stated as "hero." Child is emotional identification figure.

Adequacy of Hero: Father transforms from absent to heroic to devoted. Child is entirely passive — saved by others.

Self-Image: Vulnerable, small, at mercy of caregivers' reliability. Cannot save self. Worth depends on father's willingness to sacrifice.

3. Main Needs and Drives

- n Succorance (Child): Protection, care from father
- n Nurturance (Father, wished): Becomes devoted after crisis
- n Harm Avoidance (Child): Passive — falls, nearly bitten
- n Dominance (Father): Takes control, fires servant
- n Affiliation (Child — Father): Craves paternal bonding

Introduced: Snake (significant threat); careless servant; "out of station"; morning-only contact; father's intuition; firing servant; montage of bonding moments.

Omitted: Mother (completely absent again); self-protective capacity; peers/siblings; anger toward father.

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Dangerous when unprotected — threats emerge without reliable care. Substitutes are unreliable. But contains POSSIBILITY of rescue and reform. More hopeful than most cards, though safety depends entirely on father's presence.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Father:** Absent but fundamentally caring. Heroic when present. Capable of transformation. The wished-for ideal father.
 - **Servant:** Careless, self-interested, unreliable. All inadequate substitute caregivers.
 - **Snake:** External threat emerging in absence of protection.
 - **Mother:** Completely absent — not mentioned.
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6–8. Conflicts / Anxieties / Defenses

Conflicts: Father's presence vs. absence; trust vs. unreliability of substitutes; passivity vs. need for protection.

Anxieties: Abandonment/neglect; physical danger; separation; being forgotten; helplessness.

Defenses: Wish Fulfillment (father becomes devoted); Idealization (father has intuition, becomes perfect); Denial of anger (no anger at father); Regression (passive, waiting to be saved); Rescue Fantasy (core defense).

9. Adequacy of Superego

Proportionate. Servant punished (fired) for negligence. Father's "crime" (absence) punished through scare. Operates through natural consequences. More integrated moral reasoning.

10. Integration of the Ego

Moderate with wish-fulfillment. Coherent, logical structure. Positive imagery possible (bonding montage). But: hero entirely passive; resolution = deus ex machina; mother absent; father's transformation is magical; intensity of wish reveals its absence in reality.

CARD 10

(A child across an adult's lap; bathroom/washroom setting)

Response Summary

Parents had a love marriage, rejected by family, live alone. Their child is "evil minded" from birth — violent from early childhood (hits others until bleeding). Despite mother's best efforts, child becomes progressively worse. Eventually reveals "real evil face" to parents, imprisons them, forces them to work for his gambling/drugs. Parents try to escape but child prevents it. Eventually a family member discovers the situation, helps free parents, police arrest the child. Parents were "bohat innocent," covered up child's behaviour. They feel regret. Main characters are mother-father. Ending was not happy.

1. Main Theme

Descriptive Level: Parents in a love marriage, isolated from family, produce an inherently evil child. Despite all efforts, he becomes progressively violent, eventually imprisons his parents, exploits them. Extended family rescues parents; police arrest child.

Interpretive Level: If one produces an inherently evil child, no love or effort can change innate destructiveness. Isolation from extended family removes protective structures. Evil will overpower good.

Diagnostic Level: The "evil child" may represent AP's projected aggressive impulses — the feared, destructive part of self. Parents' helplessness despite love = good objects destroyed by the bad internal object. Imprisonment of parents = reversal of power dynamics (children controlled by parents → child controlling parents). Extended family as rescuer = desire for broader support.

Symbolic Level: Evil from birth = innate "badness" fear; Love marriage isolation = unsupported family; Imprisonment = reversal of felt powerlessness; Gambling/drugs = destructive impulses; Family rescuing = wished-for support; Regret = parents questioning choices.

2. Main Hero

Identification: Mother-Father stated as main characters. The evil child is anti-hero — possibly projection of subject's feared aggressive self.

Adequacy of Hero: Parents completely inadequate — innocent, loving, but helpless against their own child. Their goodness becomes vulnerability.

Self-Image: Complex projection. On one level: identifies with helpless parents. On another: "evil child" may represent disowned aggressive aspects AP fears in himself. "Evil from birth" = anxiety of being inherently flawed.

3. Main Needs and Drives

- n Aggression (Evil Child): Innate, escalating
- n Dominance (Evil Child): Reverses power, imprisons parents
- n Nurturance (Mother, failed): "Bohat dhyan diya but phir bhi"
- n Affiliation (Parents): Love marriage, strong bond but isolated
- n Succorance (Parents): Eventually receive family help
- n Acquisition (Evil Child): Gambling, drugs

Introduced: Love marriage/family rejection; innate evil; progressive violence; blood; imprisonment of parents; gambling/drugs; extended family rescue; parental regret.

Omitted: Professional help; any child redemption; peer influence; education; any positive child quality.

4. Conception of the Environment (World)

Innate evil exists and cannot be reformed through love. Social isolation removes protection. Eventually helpful (family discovers, police arrest) but intervention comes late. Fatalistic view of human nature.

5. Figures Seen As

- **Parents:** Loving, innocent, helpless. Goodness = vulnerability. They cover up (enabling).
 - **Evil Child:** Born bad, progressively worse. Uncontrollable force of nature. Irredeemable.
 - **Extended Family:** Initially rejecting but ultimately saving.
 - **Police:** Effective institutional authority.
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6–8. Conflicts / Anxieties / Defenses

Conflicts: Nurture vs. Nature; autonomy vs. need for support; love vs. helplessness; free will vs. determinism.

Anxieties: Fear of own innate "badness"; losing control; isolation; irredeemability; parental disappointment.

Defenses: Projection (aggressive impulses onto evil child); Splitting (parents ALL good, child ALL bad); Externalization (evil is innate, not chosen); Reversal (child over parents); Denial (parents cover behaviour); Moralization (clear moral frame).

9. Adequacy of Superego

Functional, somewhat harsh. Evil child arrested. "Not happy ending" = damage cannot be undone. Parental regret adds complexity. Punishment through institutional authority, not internal reform — child shows no remorse.

10. Integration of the Ego

Moderate with concerning content. Complex multi-stage narrative; cause-effect logic; realistic resolution; moral complexity (regret, covering up). But: innate irredeemable evil = fatalism/self-perception anxiety; power reversal themes; drugs/gambling introduced; parents' helplessness reinforces adult inadequacy; "evil child" who can't be changed may reflect fear about own "dark" impulses.

CLINICAL NOTE: "Evil from birth" concept may reflect AP's anxiety about his own aggressive impulses — fearing his darkness is innate and uncontrollable. Warrants exploration of aggressive behavioural history and self-concept regarding aggression.

COMPREHENSIVE SUMMARY AND INTEGRATION

Cross-Card Recurring Themes

1. **Parental Inadequacy/Danger** (all 10 cards): Absent, dangerous, negligent, or ineffective parents.
 2. **Death and Violence** (8/10 cards): Only Cards 4 and 5 are death-free.
 3. **Oral-Aggressive/Cannibalistic Content** (Cards 1 and 7): Highly significant repetition.
 4. **The "Middle Child" Wound** (Cards 2 and 6): Core wound — capable but unvalued, responsible but unloved.
 5. **External Rescue vs. Self-Agency**: Most cards require external rescue (police, family). Only Card 8 shows true self-agency.
 6. **Mother Absence**: Biological mother dead/absent in Cards 1, 3, 5, 6, 8, 9. When present: idealized (4) or demonized (7).
 7. **Assertion = Death** (Card 7): Speaking up against authority is punished by annihilation.
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Ego Function Assessment

Ego Function	Rating (1-7)	Evidence
Reality Testing	5	Stories internally consistent
Judgment	4	Solutions range realistic to magical
Regulation of Drives	3	Aggressive content overwhelms
Object Relations	3	Splitting; unstable representations
Thought Processes	5	Logical, coherent throughout
Defensive Functioning	3-4	Heavy primitive defenses
Stimulus Barrier	3	Easily overwhelmed
Autonomous Functions	5	Language, cognition intact
Synthetic-Integrative	4	Creates coherent wholes
Mastery-Competence	3-4	Variable: helpless to resilient

Defense Mechanism Profile

Defense	Frequency	Maturity
Splitting	Pervasive	Primitive
Projection	Very High	Primitive
Idealization	High	Primitive
Denial	High	Primitive
Reaction Formation	Moderate	Neurotic
Rationalization	Moderate	Neurotic
Turning Against Self	Moderate	Neurotic
Intellectualization	Moderate	Neurotic
Wish Fulfillment	Moderate	Immature
Externalization	Moderate	Immature
Sublimation	Low (Card 8)	Mature

Assessment: Predominantly primitive and neurotic defenses. Very limited access to mature defenses. Pervasive splitting, projection, and idealization suggest pre-oedipal level object relations functioning despite adequate cognitive capacity.

Primary Needs (Murray) — Ranked

Rank	Need	Cards
1	n Affiliation/Love (unmet)	All 10
2	n Harm Avoidance	8/10
3	n Succorance	7/10
4	n Aggression (projected)	6/10
5	n Autonomy (often forced)	5/10
6	n Recognition (unmet)	4/10
7	n Achievement	4/10
8	n Nurturance (forced giving)	4/10

Primary Presses (Murray) — Ranked

Rank	Press	Cards
1	p Aggression (physical)	8/10
2	p Rejection	7/10
3	p Loss	6/10
4	p Dominance	6/10
5	p Physical Danger	5/10
6	p Lack/Deprivation	5/10
7	p Entrapment	4/10

Diagnostic Impressions

1. **Depressive Features with Passive Suicidal Ideation** (Card 2): Worthlessness, expendability, "mere marne se loss kam hai."
2. **Aggressive Drives with Inadequate Containment**: Oral-cannibalistic content (Cards 1, 7); extreme violence; aggression projected onto authority figures.
3. **Object Relations Disturbance**: Pervasive splitting; inability to integrate ambivalence; no "good-enough" mother/father.
4. **Attachment Insecurity** (likely Disorganized): No secure base; caregivers unreliable or dangerous; forced self-reliance.
5. **Parentification and Role Reversal**: Child protects mother (4); older children parent younger (6); child tells father truth (8).
6. **Sibling Rivalry and Perceived Unfair Treatment**: Core wound across Cards 2 and 6.
7. **Fear of Assertion**: Speaking up = death (Card 7); being "smart" is worthless (Card 2); older children accept silently (Card 6).

Clinical Recommendations

1. **Suicidal Ideation Assessment**: Card 2's content warrants direct inquiry about passive/active suicidal thoughts.
2. **Family Dynamics**: Parental favouritism, sibling treatment, emotional neglect — explore in relation to actual family.
3. **Aggression Assessment**: Extreme content — explore experienced/witnessed aggression and subject's own impulse management.
4. **Attachment History**: Early attachment, maternal consistency, paternal presence.

5. **Domestic Violence Screening:** Card 7 narrative warrants screening.
 6. **Self-Concept:** How AP perceives his place, value, and worth in family.
 7. **Coping Resources:** Card 8 shows healthy capacity — therapeutic work should strengthen these.
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Formulation

AP, 16 years old, presents a CAT-H protocol characterized by pervasive themes of violence, parental inadequacy, emotional deprivation, and sibling-based worthlessness. The core psychological constellation centres on:

A deep sense of being invisible, unvalued, and expendable within the family system — particularly in contrast to a favoured younger sibling and an academically superior older sibling. This perceived worthlessness generates significant depressive ideation (including passive suicidal themes framed as "logical" self-sacrifice) and massive aggressive fantasy (projected onto parental figures as cannibalistic/murderous behaviour). The ego, while cognitively intact, is overwhelmed by primitive aggressive and depressive content, relies heavily on splitting and projection, and has limited access to mature defensive operations. Object relations are at a pre-oedipal level (part-object relating, all-good/all-bad splitting). Card 8 demonstrates that therapeutic potential exists — the subject CAN mobilize perseverance, confrontation, and sublimation when the narrative supports it.

Analysis prepared using Bellak's 10 Variables System for CAT-H Interpretation (Leopold Bellak, M.D., Fifth Edition) with Murray's Need-Press Framework.

Date of Analysis: ____

Examiner: ____